



Higher Professional Training Course in Cybersecurity

2025/2026

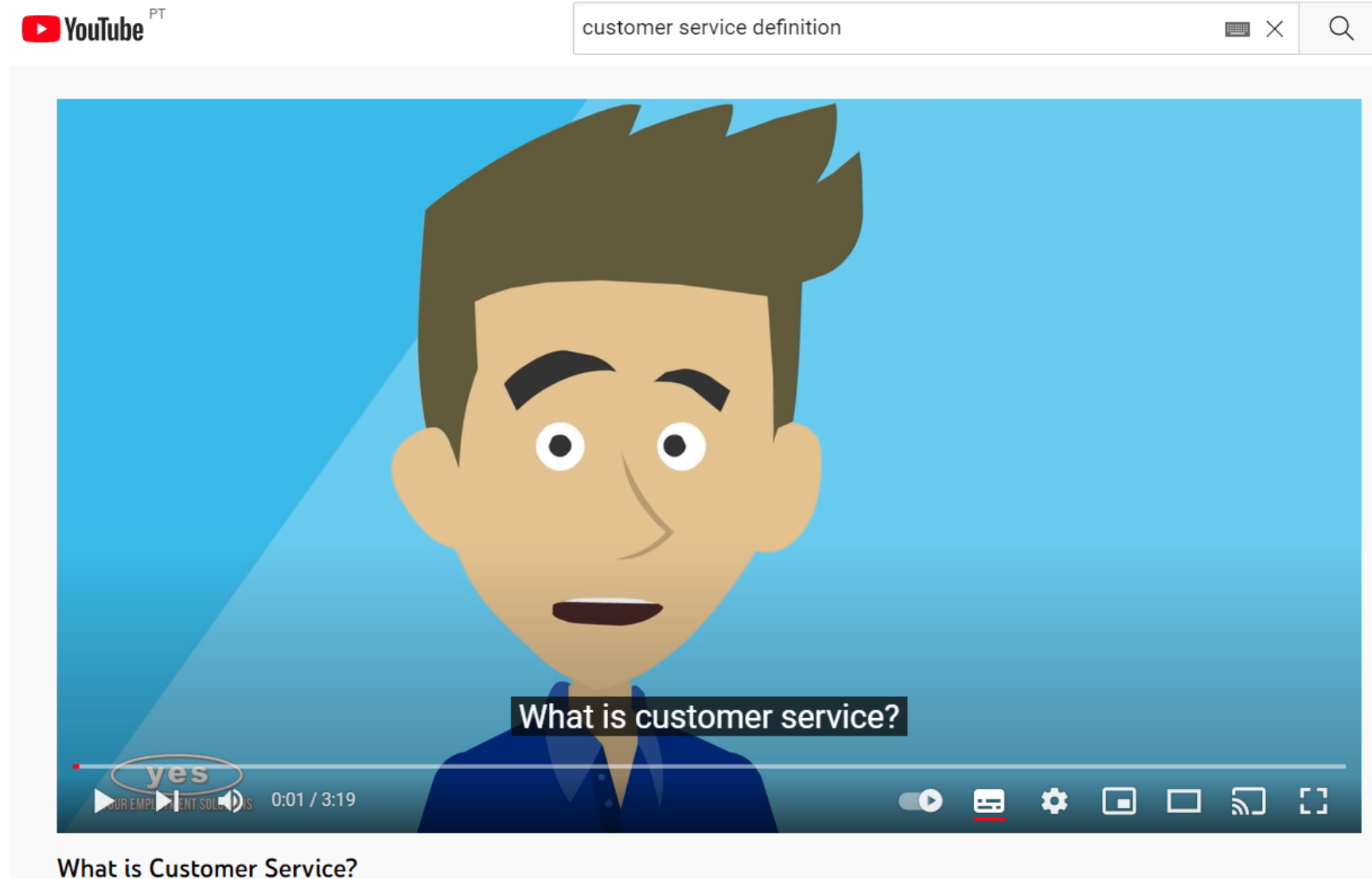


Customer Service

English Applied to Computer Science (18117)

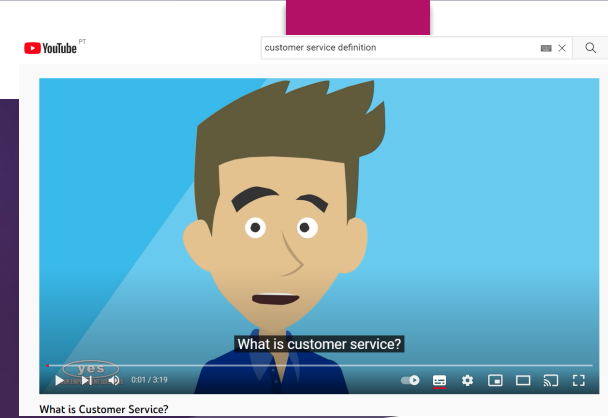
Teacher | Madalena Tavares (madalenatavares@ua.pt)

Watch the video and take some notes!



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IBb6l6ANf4c>

What is Customer Service?



What is Customer Service?



- ▶ the part of an organization that answers customers' questions, exchanges goods that are not satisfactory;

What is Customer Service?



- the fact of treating customers in a polite and helpful way, which is considered an important part of running a good business;

What is Customer Service?



- the way that an organization deals with customers before, during, and after a sale, and the activities involved in dealing with customers;

What is Customer Service?



- the department of an organization that gives help to customers and deals with their problems.

Customer Service Fundamentals



Reliability:

The hability to provide what was promised, dependably and accurately



Assurance

The knowledge and courtesy you show to customers and your ability to convey trust, competence and confidence.



Tangibles

The physical facilities and equipment, and your own and others appearance.



Empathy

The degree of caring and individual attention you show to customers.



Responsiveness

The willingness to help customers promptly.

How? By being FOCUS

F = Being **fair**

O = Asking
open ended
questions

C = Showing
concern

U = Remember that
each customer is
unique

S = Putting a
smile on your
face, voice
and attitude.



Skills for Customer Service Jobs



Clear
Communication



Listening
Skills



Self-Control



Positive
attitude



Assertiveness



Conflict
Resolution



Empathy



Depersonalization



Taking
Responsibility



A sense
of humor

Giving Advice



To give advice, you can:

- ▶ Use the modal verb 'should' (affirmative / negative) (e.g. You shouldn't use emoticons.)
- ▶ Use an imperative (e.g. Avoid using emoticons. / Don't use emoticons.)
- ▶ Use other expressions such as:
 - **I recommend that** you use a more formal style. / **I recommend** using a more formal style.
 - **It's a good idea** to use a more formal style.
 - **The best thing to do is** to use a more formal style.

Giving Instructions



'Start' button → 'Control Panel' → 'System and Security' heading → under 'System': 'View amount of RAM and processor speed'

- ▶ **IT help desk technician** : First, could you click on the 'Start' button?
- ▶ **IT user** : Sure.
- ▶ **IT help desk technician** : Then select 'Control Panel'. A box will appear.
- ▶ **IT user** : OK.
- ▶ **IT help desk technician** : Click where it says 'System and Security', then 'View amount of RAM and processor speed' under 'System'.
- ▶ **IT user** : Got it! Thank you very much.

Giving Instructions

Work in pairs.

Take turns being an IT help desk technician and an IT user. Use these prompts to explain to your partner how to follow the steps for each action.

'Start' button → Mozilla Firefox → double click/title bar

Right-click on 'c:' drive → 'Properties' → 'Sharing' tab → 'Advanced Sharing' → 'Share this folder' check box → 'OK' → 'Close'

Press 'Start' key and 'E' key to open Windows explorer → 'Uninstall or change a program' at top → find 'Anki' → right-click → select 'Uninstall'

Find clock on bottom right of screen → right-click it → 'Adjust date/time' in pop-up menu → 'Change time zone' button → '(UCT+09.00) Osaka, Sapporo, Tokyo' in drop-down menu → 'OK' → 'OK'

Let's practise!

- ▶ You work as an IT help desk technician. You are responsible for these tickets from colleagues in your company. Read the tickets.
- ▶ What are the problems?



Help Desk ticket	
Date	10.11
Name	Ben
Problem	I can't print out.
Contact	0504446231
Service Person	You

Help Desk ticket	
Date	11.11
Name	Clare
Problem	I can't connect to the network.
Contact	0504445558
Service Person	You

Help Desk ticket	
Date	12.11
Name	Simone
Problem	My computer fan is very noisy.
Contact	0504446553
Service Person	You



Let's Roleplay!

Roleplay the conversations about the problems.
Student A is the help desk technician and Student B is the colleague.

Types of Customer Service



Phone



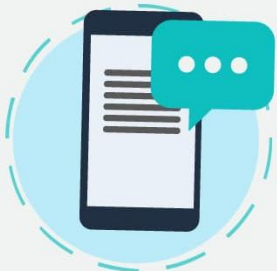
Text Message



Email



Self-service



Messaging



Social Media



Live Chat



In-person

Delivering customer care through writing



STARTER

Do this quick quiz about writing for customer care. Say whether the statements are true (T) or false (F). Then compare your answers with a partner.

- 1 The content of a letter or an email is more important than correct spelling and punctuation.
- 2 It's always better to send an email than to phone a customer.
- 3 You should always write to new customers in a formal style.
- 4 If you can understand what you wrote in a letter, then your customer can too.
- 5 If you have a spellchecker on your computer, you don't need to re-read letters or emails before sending them.
- 6 Emails should normally be short and concise.
- 7 If a customer's email or letter is informal, then your reply should also be informal.
- 8 It's OK to send out standard letters to any customer enquiry.
- 9 Customers appreciate smileys and other fun graphics in emails.

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Look at these excerpts from customer care letters and emails. Which one is?

- 1 an invitation? ☐
- 2 a follow-up to a meeting? ☐
- 3 a reply to an enquiry? ☐
- 4 a promise to send something? ☐
- 5 a request for information? ☐

a

Hello Mr Sutton

In answer to your email, our shop in Stratford is open Mondays to Saturdays from 9 a.m. to 8 p.m. You can reach us by fax on 0763 449 923.

Please feel free to get in touch if you have any more questions.

Regards
Lara Jones

b

Hi Oliver

We're having a small party at the Wilton Hotel this Friday at 7 p.m. We're asking a few of our most important clients to attend and I would be pleased if you could join us. Let me know if you can come ...

Best wishes
Jim

c

Dear Mrs Demetrios

Thanks so much for your phone call yesterday. I am pleased to tell you that we can handle your order. Would you like to pay by credit card or bank transfer? Please fill in the attached form and fax it to me. Then I can send it out to you today.

Best regards
Jeannette Donaldson

d

Dear Mr Blair

In regard to our meeting yesterday, I would just like to confirm what we agreed. First of all, ...

Sincerely yours
Franco Manzetti

e

Robert

I got your message this afternoon. Sure, I'll talk to Ruth and email you the price list today. Do you also need our latest brochure?

Take care
Carola

Salutations and Closes



CUSTOMER FOCUS EXTRA

Salutations and closes

When you write to a customer for the first time, it is often best to use a formal style. Then look at how the customer answers. Is the reply formal or informal? From now on, use the same register as your customer. By communicating with the customer in the way he or she prefers, you demonstrate good customer care.

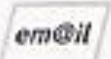
Here is an overview of standard salutations and closes used in letters and emails.

	letter	email
when you don't know the name	Dear Sir or Madam / Dear Sirs Ladies and Gentlemen (AmE)	Dear Sir or Madam / Dear Sirs Hello
	Yours faithfully (BrE) Sincerely (yours) (AmE)	(Kind/Best) Regards Best wishes
when you know the name	Dear Mr / Ms / Mrs Smith Dear Mr and Mrs Smith Dear Ms Black and Mr Smith	Dear / Hello Mr / Ms / Mrs Smith Dear / Hello Mr and Mrs Smith Dear / Hello Ms Black and Mr Smith
	Yours sincerely (BrE) Sincerely (yours) (AmE)	(Kind/Best) Regards All the best / Best wishes
when you know the person/people well	Dear John Dear Paul and Mary	Dear / Hello / Hi John Hi Paul and Mary
	Kind regards (With) best wishes	Best (wishes) / All the best Take care (AmE) / Cheers (BrE)

Note that in the US, the salutation in letters is often followed by a colon (*Dear Mr Brown:*). In the UK there is often no punctuation used here, but sometimes people put commas after both the salutation and the close (*Dear John, ... Kind regards, ...*). Whether there is a comma or not, the first word in letters and emails always starts with a capital letter.

Which salutations and closes should you use when writing to the following people?

informal

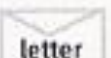
1  → Hugo Jones

Hi Hugo ... All the best

2  → Walter Rogers

3  → Mario Ingram & Janet Browne

formal

4  → Carol Elan

5  → Jeanne & Pascal Duchard

6  → name unknown

Read the letter and answer the questions.

1) How well does Richard know Mr Davis?

2) Where did they meet?

3) What did Mr Davis request?

4) What will happen next?

Horizons International

42 Windsor Street, London N1 4EJ

Tel +44 20 654 372 • Fax +44 20 654 374 • r.bird@horizint.com

John Davis
Davis & Chapman Ltd
145 Cheltenham Rd
Bristol BS6 5QZ

Dear Mr Davis

It was a pleasure meeting you recently at the Business Executive Conference. I am delighted to be able to assist you in finding a suitable IT communications system for your company. As requested, I am enclosing our latest catalogue with details and prices.

I would be grateful if we could meet soon. I will phone you on Thursday and hope we can arrange a suitable date and time.

If you have any further questions, please do not hesitate to contact me.

I look forward to welcoming you as a new and valued customer.

Yours sincerely

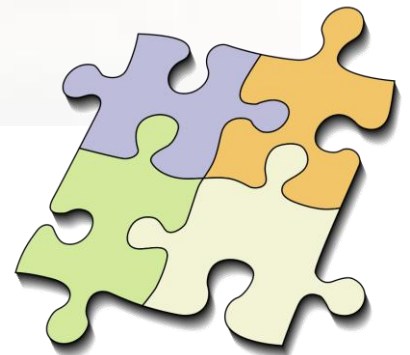
Richard Bird

Richard Bird
Sales Manager

Match the two parts to make sentences.

- 1 I look forward to
- 2 We are delighted to
- 3 If you have
- 4 Thank you
- 5 It was a pleasure to
- 6 If you are satisfied
- 7 I will pay

- a for choosing our company
- b seeing you next week
- c you a visit personally
- d any further questions
- e speak to you
- f have you as a new customer
- g with the results



Complete the sentences from letters and emails with the words from the box.

back • convenience • hearing • just • of • pleased • regard • reply • would

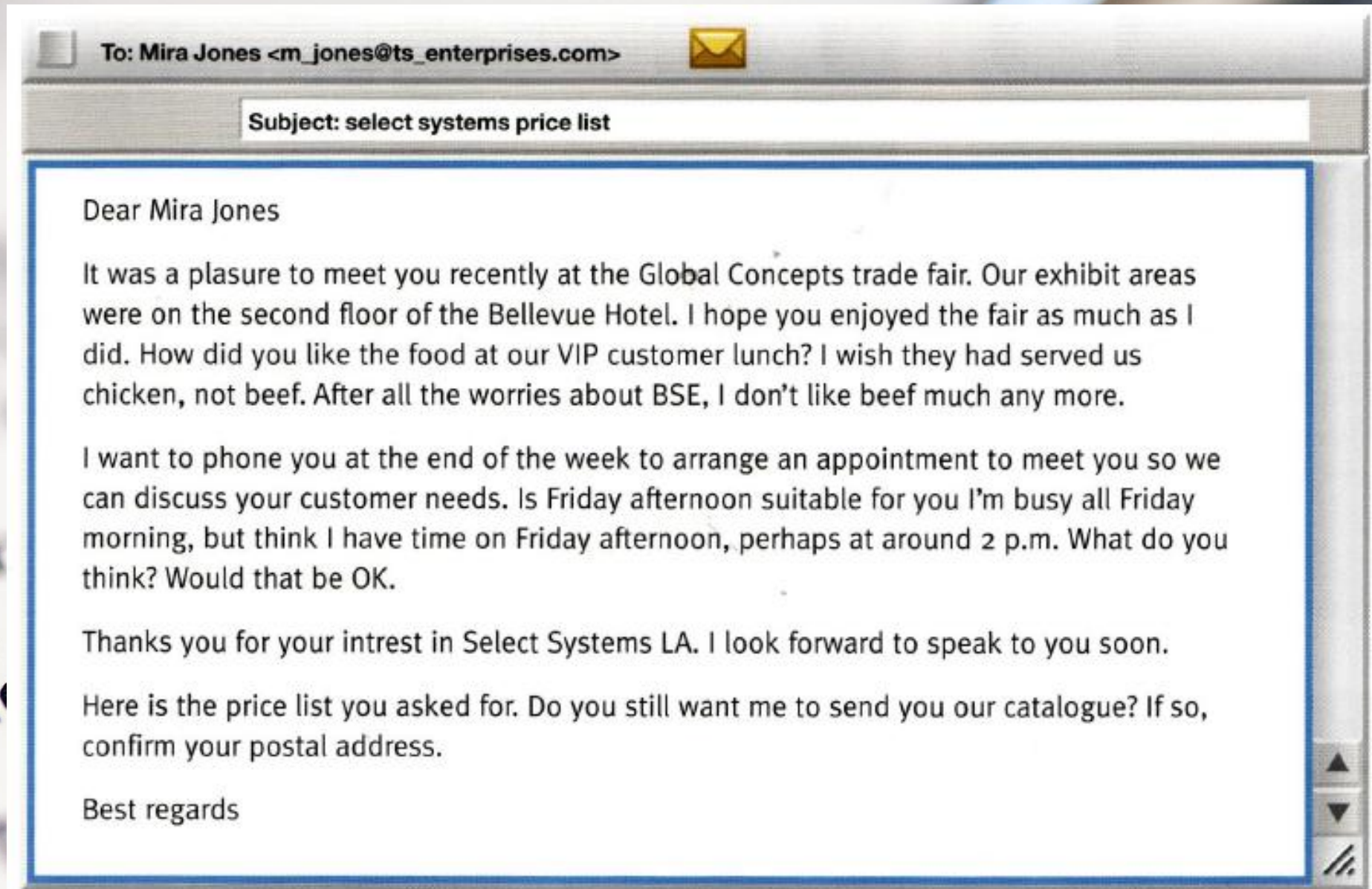
- 1 In _____ to your phone call, I am sending you the specifications for model XRT32.
- 2 We would be _____ to assist you with all your financial planning.
- 3 Thanks for your letter _____ 29 June.
- 4 I'll get _____ to you as soon as possible.
- 5 We look forward to _____ from you soon.
- 6 I _____ be grateful if you could contact me at your earliest _____.
- 7 Looking forward to your _____.
- 8 I'm _____ writing to let you know the dates of our next open house.

Five Cs of customer care writing

Follow the five Cs of customer care writing to make sure your writing is:

- Clear** Keep sentences short and direct, and have well-organized paragraphs.
- Complete** Include all the information your customer needs, including reference numbers and contact details.
- Concise** Do not waste your reader's time with too much extra information. Remember your customer is also a busy person.
- Courteous** Use polite language and follow letter-writing conventions.
- Correct** Do not distract the reader with mistakes in grammar, punctuation, and spelling. Always re-read your letter or email before sending it.

Which of the 5 Cs has the writer ignored?





DON'T FORGET!

Make sure you review your documents carefully before sending them to the customer. Like the letter or email message itself, you need to view it through the customer's eyes. Is it appropriate? Does it present a positive image? Take an extra moment to check the enclosures or attachments before you close the envelope or hit the send button!

You can use the following language to refer to the enclosed or attached documents:

letter

Please find enclosed/I am enclosing the price list you requested.

In the enclosed information packet, you will find product descriptions, ...

As you will see from the enclosed brochure, ...

email

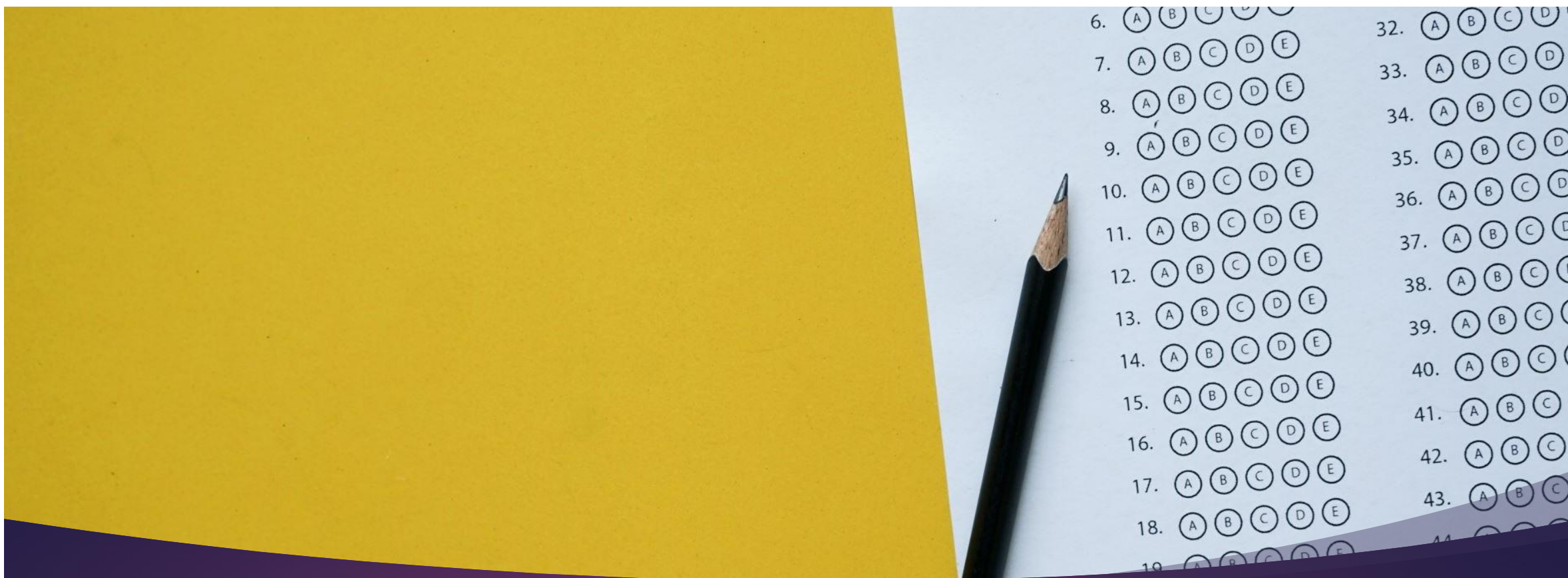
I'm sending you the current price list as an attachment.

I've attached the specifications as a pdf document.

Please complete the attached form and return it ...

Please find attached ...

Here is the file you asked for. (informal)



For further practise, solve **Unit 6 – Customer Service**
exercises in the **booklet** (pages 35 to 48)